

is essentially a connected universe of machines, a massive pool-up of resources. So the next time some smart alec tells you to “Get a file from the cloud”, all he’s really saying is, “Download the file from the combined storage arrays of some network that’s accessible over the internet.” The idea is simple. Bring together your computing infrastructure and connect it in a network, allowing a user to access data and applications from any remote location. The capabilities of the cloud concept are staggering. You can compile, edit and save documents or run entire companies using a cloud computing framework. Take the example of a company with more than a thousand employees. Buying individual workstations might be necessary, but no more does the employer have to purchase multiple software licenses, install them on each PC and monitor the usage to try and prevent piracy, etc. A single application on the system can allow each employee to access any required program hosted on a “cloud” of machines. Cloud Computing is actually shifting user machine workload and dividing it amongst the machines in the cloud network. This reduces requirements on the user side tremendously. All the user has to do then is simply connect to the cloud, run the interfacing program and allow the network to do the rest. The Cloud is revolutionising the computing industry as you read this article.

Framework and working

Cloud Computing frameworks are typically made up of a few general components. There is a back end and front end which needs to connect and communicate. This is usually achieved using the internet, which is really nothing more than the world’s biggest network. The back end as the name suggests is the “not-seen” end of the network, which is essentially the group of machines that form the cloud in question. The front end consists of the client end hardware and software that helps you access the cloud network. Front end client software usually work as independent applications. Back end of the cloud computing framework is made by hardware-like servers, processors etc. The back end will also consist of an array of software that provides the crux of the cloud service. A sample loop of this framework goes like this. A user will access the cloud using a service on his mobile device, PC, tablet, etc. This will be done using the front end software. Once access is provided the link to the cloud has been set. Now the user can use the cloud service. All the data processing and handling is done by the systems on the back end. The cloud software handles the computing involved